

Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

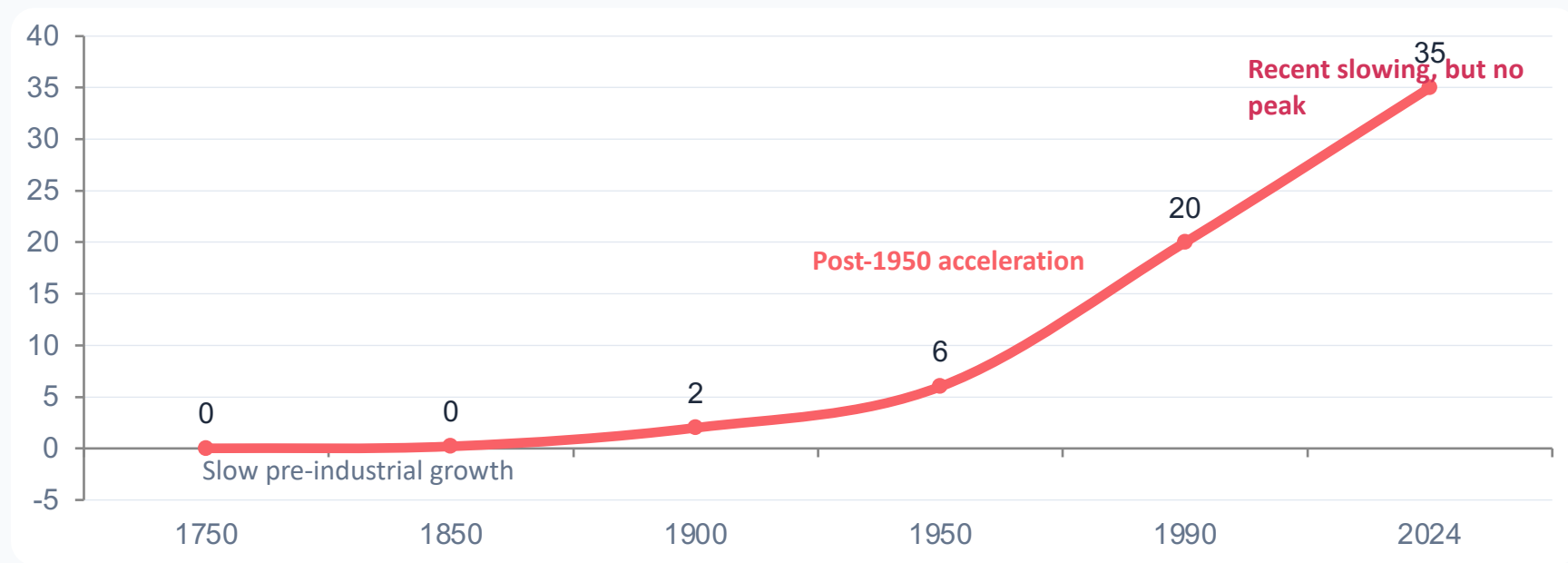
A data-driven overview from the Industrial Revolution (1750) to 2024

Prepared for: Policy Analysts, Climate Negotiators, and Sustainability Researchers

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

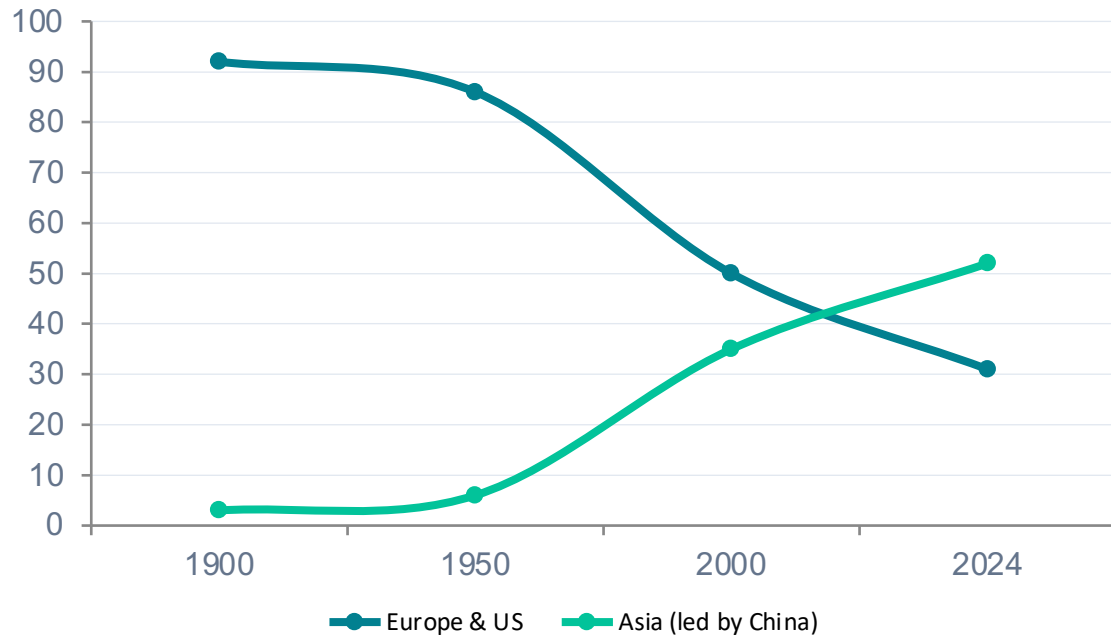
Total global CO₂ emissions from fossil fuels and industry



Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third

Dramatic shift in regional emission shares over time

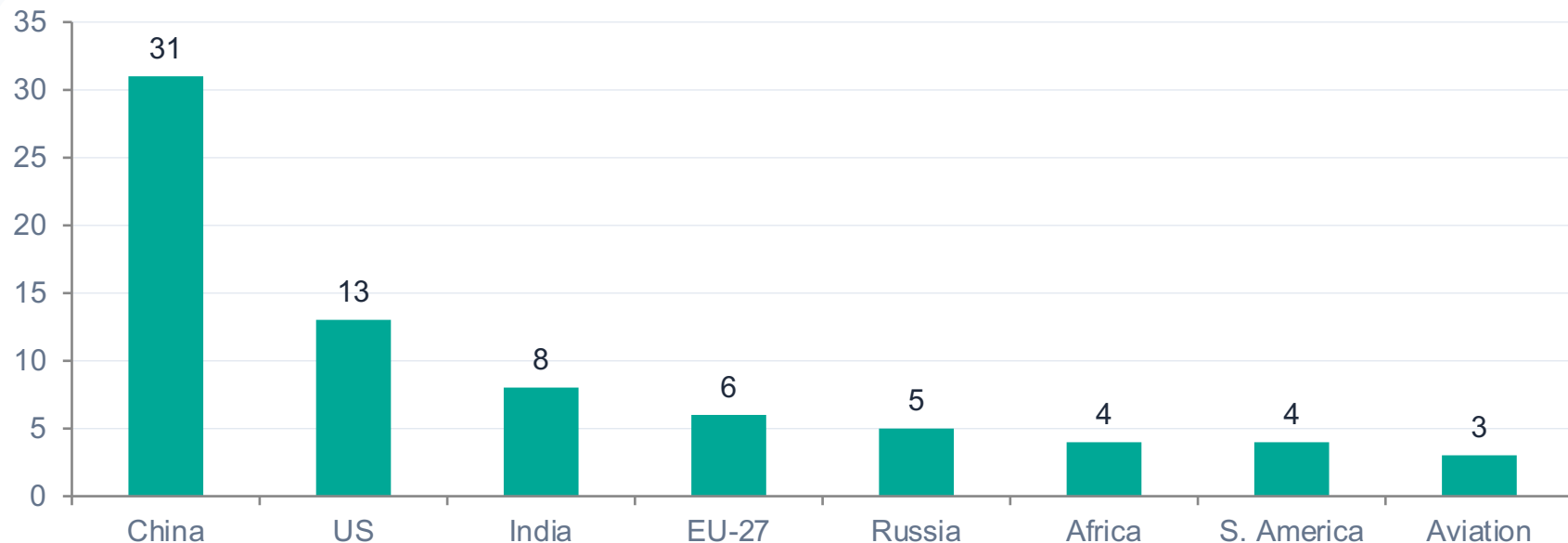
Today



1900: US & Europe:
>90%\n\n**2024:** Asia
dominates with roughly
50% of global total.

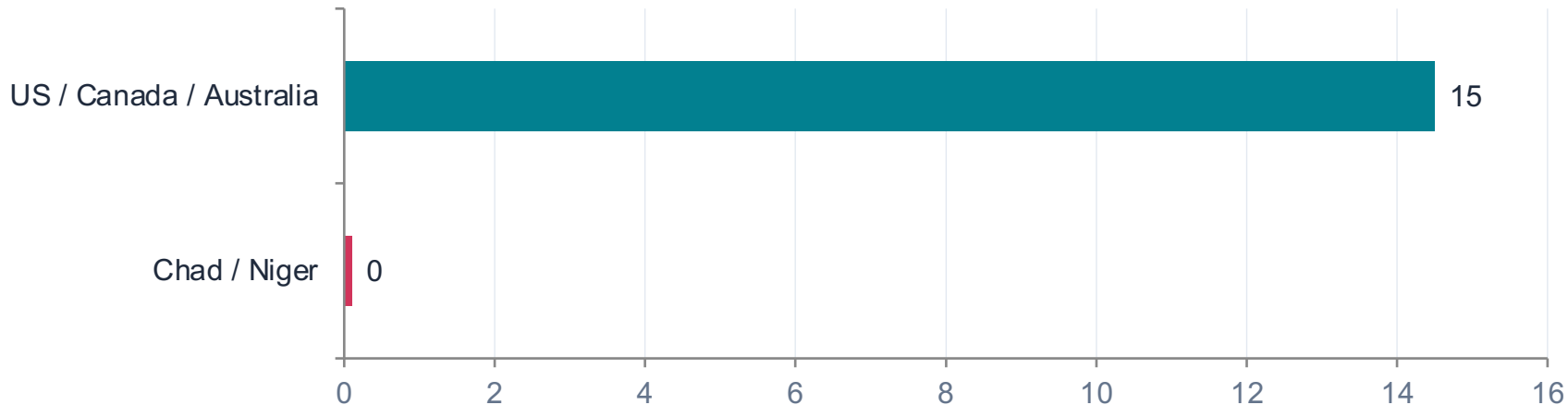
China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂

Approximate Share of Global CO₂ Emissions (2024)



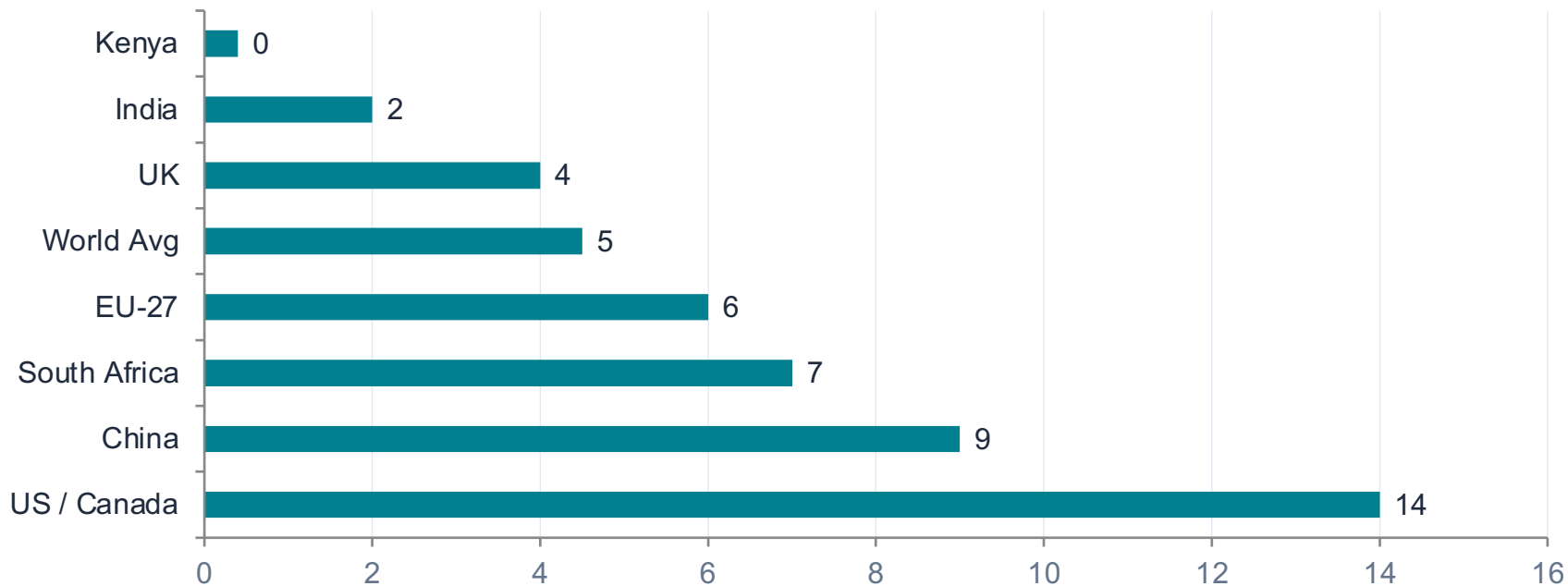
Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada

A 150x difference between the highest-emitting nations and poorest nations



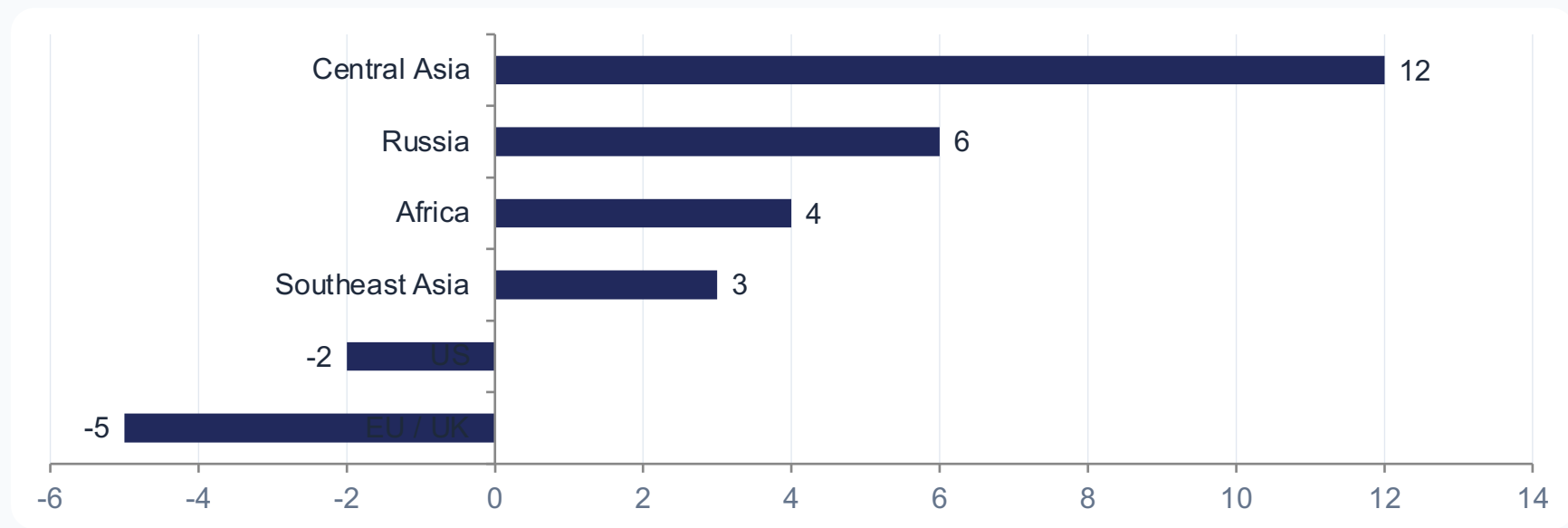
Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India

Current per capita CO₂ emissions for key countries (Tonnes per year, 2024)



2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew

Estimated Annual Percentage Change in CO₂ Emissions (2024)



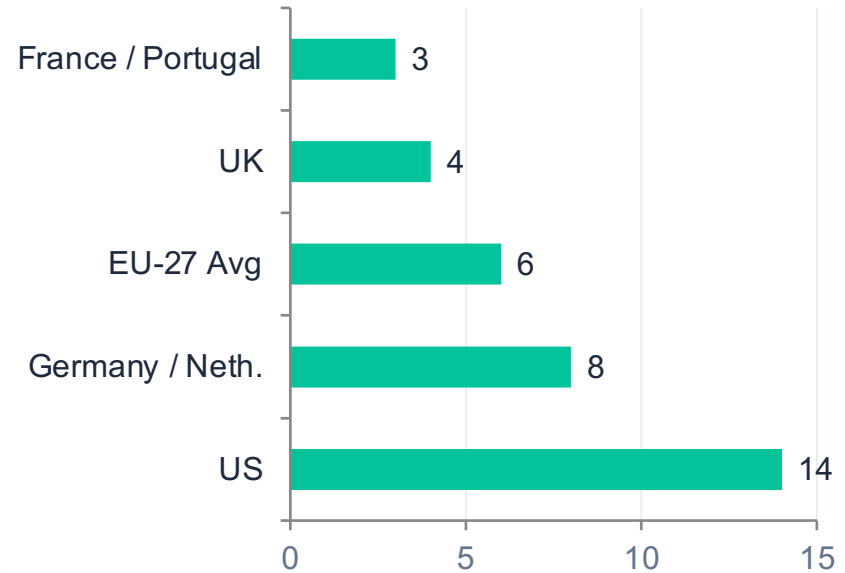
Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

Nuclear & Renewables

Decouple Prosperity from Emissions

Among wealthy nations with similar prosperity levels, per capita emissions vary significantly because of energy mix choices.

France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions largely because a higher share of their electricity comes from nuclear and renewable sources rather than fossil fuels.



Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and haven't peaked
- China is the largest annual emitter, but its per capita emissions remain below the US
- Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US (>90% in 1900)
- Per capita gaps of roughly 150x persist between the richest and poorest nations
- Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions